

HYROX

12-WEEK TRAINING PLAN

A structured, periodized program to build the strength, engine and race-specific skill needed to run 8km and hit all 8 stations with confidence.

Base Building • Build • Race-Specific • Taper

Overview

HYROX alternates 1km runs with 8 fixed stations: SkiErg (1000m), Sled Push (50m), Sled Pull (50m), Burpee Broad Jumps (80m), Rowing (1000m), Farmers Carry (200m), Sandbag Lunges (100m), and Wall Balls (75–100 reps depending on division). Training success depends on building an aerobic engine that can still perform strength-based movements under fatigue — known as **compromised running** — not just being a strong lifter or a fast runner in isolation.

Weekly Structure (4–5 sessions per week)

Day	Focus
Monday	Strength – lower body + core
Tuesday	Intervals / compromised running
Wednesday	Station skill work + Zone 2 easy run
Thursday	Strength – upper body + core
Friday	Rest or mobility
Saturday	Long simulation / HYROX "brick" workout
Sunday	Long easy run or full rest

General principle: train the aerobic engine most of the week, add strength twice weekly, and periodically simulate race conditions so your body learns to run on tired legs. Sleep, mobility and a genuine rest day matter as much as the sessions themselves.

PHASE 1 Base Building**Weeks 1–4**

- **Strength:** Squats, deadlifts, lunges, push/pull — 3 sets of 8–10 reps, moderate load, focus on clean form.
- **Running:** 2–3 easy Zone 2 runs (30–45 min) plus 1 interval session, e.g. 6×400m at moderate-hard pace.
- **Stations:** Learn technique for sled push/pull, wall balls, and burpee broad jumps — light loads, high reps, quality over intensity.
- **Simulation:** None yet — just station circuits, e.g. 3 rounds of 250m row, 20 wall balls, 200m farmers carry.

Sample Week (Weeks 1–4)

Day	Session
Mon	Strength: back squat 3x8, RDL 3x10, walking lunges 3x12/leg, plank 3x45s
Tue	Intervals: 10 min warm-up jog, 6x400m @ hard effort (90s rest), 10 min cool-down
Wed	Skill: sled push/pull technique x6 short reps, 30 min Zone 2 easy run
Thu	Strength: bench/OHP 3x8, bent-over row 3x10, farmers carry 3x40m, core circuit
Fri	Rest or 20 min mobility + stretching
Sat	Circuit: 3 rounds – 250m row, 20 wall balls, 200m farmers carry, 15 burpee broad jumps
Sun	45–60 min easy long run or full rest

- **Strength:** Increase load on main lifts; add weighted lunges and heavier farmers carries as dedicated strength work.
- **Running:** Introduce compromised runs — e.g. 1km run + station + 1km run, repeated 3–4 times.
- **Threshold work:** Intervals at goal race pace, e.g. 5×1km at target race pace with 90s rest.
- **Simulation:** Half-HYROX (4 stations + 4km running) every 2 weeks to track progress.

Sample Week (Weeks 5–8)

Day	Session
Mon	Strength: back squat 4x6 (heavier), deadlift 3x6, weighted lunges 3x10/leg
Tue	Compromised run: 1km run + 20 wall balls + 1km run + sled push 4x20m, x3 sets
Wed	Threshold: 5x1km @ goal race pace (90s rest), 20 min easy Zone 2
Thu	Strength: heavier farmers carry 4x50m, pull-ups/rows 4x8, weighted plank
Fri	Rest or mobility + foam rolling
Sat	Half-HYROX simulation (every other week): 4km run + 4 stations at race intensity
Sun	60 min easy long run

PHASE 3**Race-Specific****Weeks 9–11**

- **Race simulation:** Full or near-full HYROX once every 10–14 days to rehearse pacing and transitions.
- **Sled work:** Practice at your actual race weight for your division.
- **Transitions:** Practice moving straight from running into a station without pausing to recover first.
- **Strength:** Reduce max-strength volume; keep 1–2 short, heavy sessions to maintain strength without adding fatigue.

Sample Week (Weeks 9–11)

Day	Session
Mon	Strength (short & heavy): squat 3x5, deadlift 2x5, core finisher
Tue	Race-pace intervals: 4x1km @ race pace directly into station work (sled, wall balls)
Wed	Technique polish on weakest station + 30 min easy run
Thu	Strength (short & heavy): press 3x5, row 3x6, farmers carry at race weight
Fri	Rest or light mobility
Sat	Full HYROX simulation (every 10–14 days) at race effort
Sun	Easy recovery run or full rest depending on simulation load

PHASE 4**Taper****Week 12**

- Cut overall volume by roughly 40–50% while keeping some intensity so legs stay sharp.
- Light technique work on your weakest station only — nothing new, nothing heavy.
- Full rest for 2 days immediately before race day.
- Carb-load and rehearse your exact race-day nutrition and hydration plan in the final week.

Notes & Race-Week Checklist

Key Reminders

- Aerobic base (Zone 2) should make up the majority of weekly running volume — resist the urge to run every session hard.
- Two strength sessions per week is enough during in-season training; more risks interfering with running recovery.
- Simulate race conditions regularly in Phases 2–3 so pacing and transitions become automatic.
- Sleep, hydration, and one genuine full-rest day per week are non-negotiable, not optional extras.
- Track your station splits during simulations to identify your single weakest link and prioritize it.

Race Week Checklist

- ■ Final full HYROX simulation completed 10–14 days out (not race week itself)
- ■ Race-day nutrition and hydration plan rehearsed in training
- ■ Sled weight and wall ball weight for your division confirmed
- ■ Kit packed: shoes, grips, chalk, gloves if used, water bottle
- ■ 2 full rest days scheduled immediately before race day
- ■ Course/venue logistics (parking, check-in time, warm-up area) confirmed

This plan is a general framework. Adjust loads, paces and volumes to your current fitness level, and consult a coach or medical professional if you're new to structured training or returning from injury.